Dead Poets Society | Student Worksheet

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Directions: Write brief answers. Use character choices and scene evidence for analysis.

Before viewing

1. How can a poem support more than one interpretation?

During viewing

2. What values does Welton emphasize at the opening?

3. How does Keating’s first lesson differ from the school’s formal atmosphere?

4. What does carpe diem mean in the lesson?

5. How does standing on the desk illustrate perspective?

6. Why do the students restart the Dead Poets Society?

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During viewing

7. How does Todd’s reluctance differ from Neil’s enthusiasm?

8. Why is Neil’s interest in acting a source of conflict?

9. How do Neil’s performance and his father’s response create tension?

10. What does Todd’s final gesture communicate?

After viewing

11. Choose a scene in which language helps a student express something new.

12. Does the film present all acts of rebellion as equally thoughtful?

13. What would close reading a poem add beyond watching its use in the film?

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